



A Clash of Titans

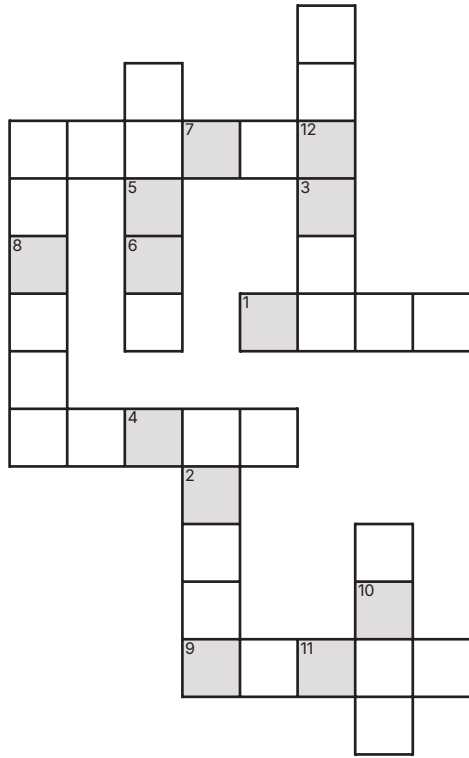
The Pantheon in Rome was built to celebrate all of the gods, but even it can't capture the full breadth of deities in the world. In many mythologies, the difference between gods and devilry is really in the fine print.



This puzzle uses a type of clue known as Printer's Devilry, where a word (the answer) has been excised from a sentence and needs to be added back in, sometimes shifting word breaks and punctuation.

For example, the sentence "His presence MA lagers cower in fear" doesn't make a ton of sense, but by adding the word 'DEVIL' and changing the word breaks, you can make it say "His presence maDE VILlagers cower in fear", which is a lot more sensible. 'DEVIL' is the answer to that clue, and is thematically relevant to the content of the sentence.

- The jackal-headed Egyptian god Anubis was revered as the overseer of the afterlife and mummification. If you look at ancient painting St. how shim weighing the souls of the dead against the Feather of Truth. (6)
- Many pantheons have concepts of an afterlife or paradise, but Revelations in the Christian bible speaks specifically of walking Tue of pure gold toward the pearly gates. (6)
- The Roman god Jupiter was hidden away and replaced with a swaddled rock after hi sot swallowed by their father Saturn. Jupiter freed the siblings and overthrew the titans to become ruler of Olympus. (4)
- In the Hindu creation cycle, Brahma springs from Vishnu's navel and creates time, space, and all beings. Vishnu, the preserver, sleeps on the cosmic ocean while this ping his body unfolds. (5)
- After Hermes stole Apollo's cattle, the Greek messenger go dab stored the peace with music. (4)
- The mayan gods attempted to make humans out of wood and discarded them, before finding the coms to unlock success and made man from local maize. (6)
- The Celtic goddess Brigid represented a great deal of positive values like inspiration, healing, and fertility. Her influence has remained in modern Ireland even after the arrival of Christianity, where she adapted into another form and took a place alongside moth Erte re he church. (5)
- Vulcan, the Roman god of fire and metalworking, was also the patron of craftsmen. He represented the use of intellect over physical perfection in at aust rated often with a limp or other deformity. (5)
- Chinese folk mythology mostly focuses on one's own ancestors and local spirits, but one iconic figure is the mischievous monkey king Sun Wukong. He was born on the mountain of flowers and fruit, where the essence of the earth, sun, and moon were absorbed for thousands of years and at la day an egg emerged. (5)



1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 11 12

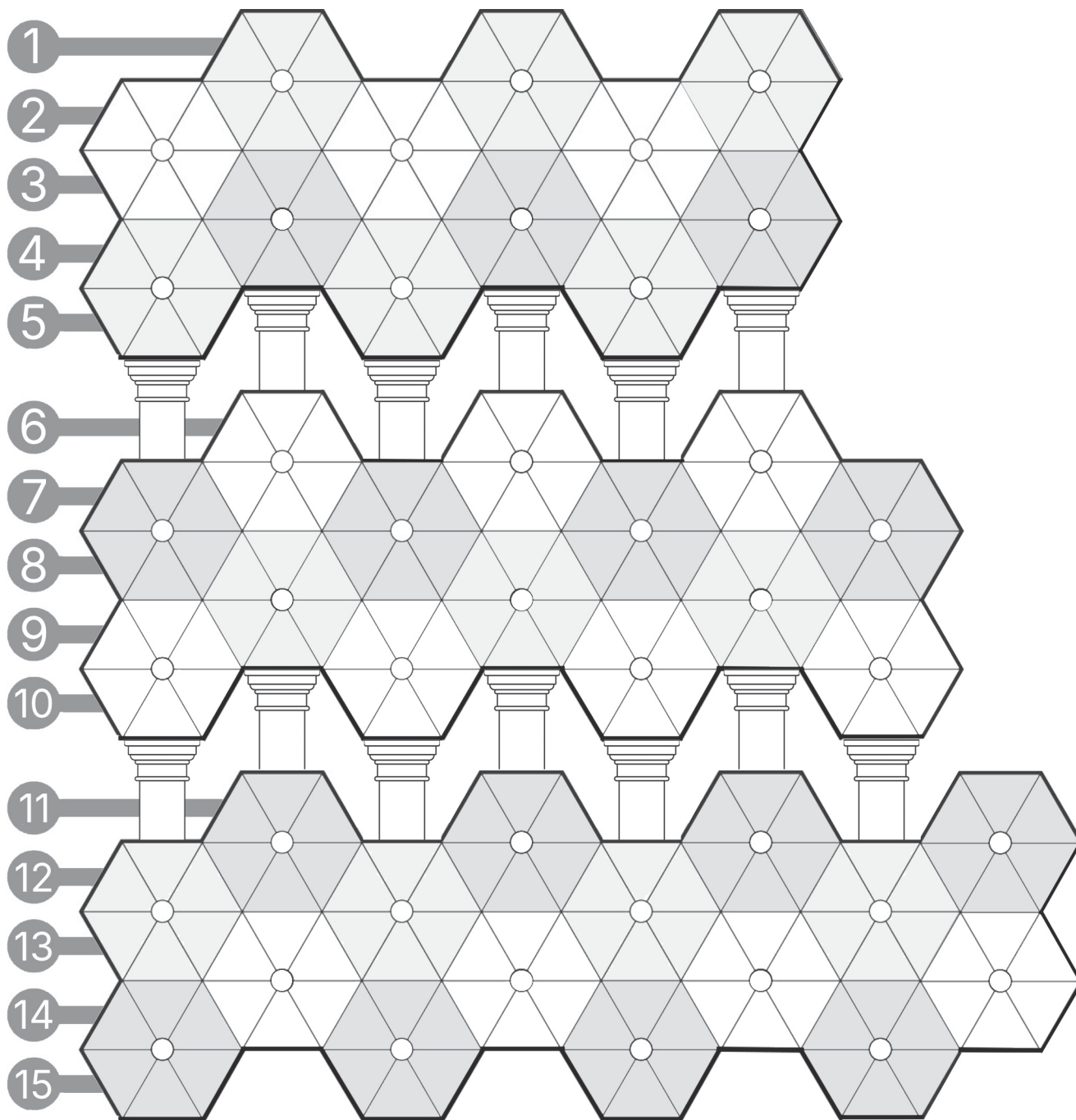


Hanging Rows Garden

The famed Hanging Gardens of Babylon were probably more tiered than actually hanging, but were still a masterwork of horticulture, demonstrating almost-complete mastery of many gardening techniques and tools.



This is a variation on a rows garden puzzle. In a typical rows garden, each numbered row contains one or more answers, concatenated together. Each shaded (or white) hexagon represents a “bloom”, which is clued separately. Typically, blooms are always 6-letter answers, but can start at any position and go either clockwise or counterclockwise. The bloom clues here have additionally been grouped by whether they go with the top, middle, or bottom set of blooms, but within a group, the clues are alphabetized by answer.



Rows

1. Male magic users (9)

2. Time long past, wistfully (6 3)
Titular latin lover from a Lady Gaga song (9)

3. Unfertile (6)
Curved sword, maybe rattled at a Brit (5)
What fools these be, according to Puck (7)

4. Kvetch much? (8 1 3)
Hale-Bopp, Shoemaker-Levy, et al (6)

5. Sudden deceleration (5 4)

6. Whale hunter, or perhaps a New England brewery fan? (9)
7. Made amends for (6)
French poetic form associated with round dances (6)
Font (9)

8. Sign up for again (10)
Somber and wise in appearance (6)
Blacksmith's ear bone? (5)

9. Word preceding books, museum, or hospital (9)
Manchurian Candidate, e.g. (7 5)

10. The Lone Ranger's horse (6)
Stick around, like perfume (6)

11. Infatuate (6)
More like Felix of The Odd Couple (6)
12. Not hold 'em, fold 'em, or run (4 4)
Content of a blue book at exam time (5)
Comfy three-sectioned furniture pieces (6 5)

13. Gets too big for (8)
Verbal back-and-forth (8)
Like Claire Danes' life? (2-6)

14. Children get hooked on it (7)
One on a violent tear (8)
Like a crocodile, or purportedly many politicians (9)

15. Jotted down (5)
American settler or unmanned space probe (7)

Blooms

	Light Blooms	Medium Blooms	Dark Blooms
Rows 1–5	- Degrading one - Like a baby who wants a toy - Condom for Ajax?	<i>Decaying material good for your garden</i> <i>Slow wearing away over time</i> - Chocolate coffees - Commands - Adjust shoe tension, perhaps - Good mental health	- Oft-blended red wine <i>Decorative container where flowers live</i> - Runs to second after the play, perhaps
Rows 6–10	- Scotch bonnets and Carolina Reapers, e.g. - Set, as epoxy - First words of rickroll choruses - Of the male, ahem, member - Gathered, like fallen rain - One who rules when the king is a child - One who pays the landlord's bills	- Abdominal shaping garment - Airplane house <i>Tiny shovels for your garden</i>	<i>Machine that stabs holes in the ground</i> - The kind of dead that zombies are - Male counterparts of sopranos <i>Lattice for vines to climb</i>
Rows 11–15	- Chevy antelope? - Succeeded at (it), especially sarcastically <i>A designation for produce</i> - A state of tranquility	- Billy the Kid or Jesse James - Comfort - Gently moved in the wind - Thick fermented dairy food	- Pictures of acne-free skin, perhaps - Of a Swiss mountain range - Rouse - Quagmire, or a larger posterior? - Understood, grammatically <i>White granules mixed into potting soil</i> - Gamma ray particle - Area



Links

The ARPAnet taught us that when going from A to B it's important to track all of the twists and turns.



1. A grievance
2. Remember
3. Utterly defeat
4. Practical; unpretentious
5. Locally sourced
6. Completely; entirely
7. Intimate
8. The best

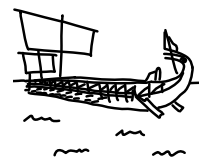
	H	U	R	U	F	N	L	O	N
F	G	E	I	N	S	Y	D		O
O		V	O	D	L	U	S	L	S
L		R	A	A	T	K	I	I	S
L	E	O		I	T		L		W
C	N	N	U	N			A	V	C
S	T	I	R	G	E	P	H	E	T
N	O		A			T	H	R	R
X	E	P	E	I	W	N		I	U
O	C	O	M			E	S	E	

Connect A to B with a path through the sides of the squares. Paths cannot branch nor cross.



My Immortal Shiptoast

If you take the Ship of Theseus/Minotaur, and you swap Theseus out for Argus and then the Minotaur out for the Gorgon, is it still the same ship, or does it become Argon?



Bella Swan and Edward Cullen were having a romantic dinner on their favorite cruise ship. "Bella", Edward said, raising a glass, "let's have a toast to our relationship." "I don't know, Edward," Bella said. "Have you seen the name they've been giving our ship on the internet? I'm not sleepy yet, and I'm not sure I want to head in that direction. I think we might have to break up." [A/N I actually really like this ship because it has my sixth, tenth, eleventh, and twelfth favorite characters but oh well]

Edward ran away crying. A lady smiled at Bella and sat down across from her. "Hello, sweetie," she said as she set her cocktail down on the table. "I never thanked you for that screwdriver you gave me." Bella stared at her confused but also with a sense of strange familiarity. "Do I know you? When did I give you a screwdriver? We've only just met." The lady just smiled at Bella. "Spoilers, this is *your* first meeting" Bella started to tremble. "But the name of our ship indicates this could be our final adventure, and that won't do. We'll have to break up." [A/N This only featured my fourth and fifth favorite characters, must be a sign it was doomed]

Bella left, passing a mercenary as he strolled up to the table. He stopped, took a long, deep look at her. "Lady, aren't you a sight for sore eyes. I've been stuck with this guy who smells like some kind of angry animal and could go for a quick fling." The lady paged through her book, pretending not to hear him as he continued: "Oh my, reader. What's that it said? She's pretending not to hear me? Maybe if I compare her to the other folks in this fanfic she'll appreciate me more." The lady looked up at him all red in the face, looking as if he had two black eyes. "They say this ship is supposed to be like a nice, calming beverage, and this isn't working at all. We're going to have to break up." [A/N This had more of my favorite characters, featuring the third, fourth, fifth, and ninth, but still not good enough]

As the lady walked away, a girl walked up who looked like a rag doll. (or maybe, she had just once received a rag doll that looked uncannily like her—did she ever have her eyes replaced with buttons?) The mercenary cocked his head to contemplate this fact, and then smiled at her and said, "She approaches, with beautifully gleaming un-be-buttoned eyes! She must have returned that doll before the time limit that is our ship." [A/N this is a good one!! It has my third, fifth, eighth, ninth, tenth, and eleventh favorite characters.]

The mercenary sauntered away, and out of nowhere appeared an old soldier with a bandana to take his place. "I didn't even see you approach" said the rag doll girl as she stared into his eye. "How did you get here? There's nowhere you could have hidden." She curled up against him as a waiter came by to pick up a cardboard box that was on the floor near the table. "I heard you used to raise dogs of some sort. Were they wolfhounds?" "No, foxhounds," he replied, cradling her closer. "Oh. This won't do at all," she sobbed. "Our ship is too cute to have such a venomous name. We have to stop seeing each other." [A/N two good ones in a row!! This has my third, fourth, fifth, ninth, eleventh, and twelfth favorite characters]

As the rag-doll girl stepped away, a man approached in a blue hooded cape. "I've walked over so many magic planes to get to you, my dear", the hooded man said, as he heard the soldier think, *did he say plains? I thought he was more of an islands guy?* and smirked to himself. The soldier stared into his all-knowing blue eyes, and thought to himself, *our ship name gives me comfort when his eyes stare unsettlingly into my mind. I wonder if he can read my thoughts.* The hooded man blinked. [A/N This ship is only ok, but at least it's got my third, fourth, ninth and eleventh favorite characters!]

The soldier broke eye contact and nervously chuckled, and then made his excuses and snuck off. The hooded man felt someone approaching from behind and didn't turn around. He felt her thoughts roil with excitement at the prospect of being choked by a mysterious hooded stranger, and thought to himself, *sounds about par for an incompetent secretary and ditzy heiress, especially one who works for a stupid spy organization.* He briefly thought about indulging her and instead let out a loud burp. That's us if we were to date, he thought to himself with a suppressed giggle. *I'm the ship.* [A/N

ok kind of a weird one but it's got my third, sixth, ninth, eleventh, twelfth favorite characters okkk]

The hooded man decided instead to head out, leaving the ditzzy heiress to sit by herself at the table. A head cheerleader from Riverdale High School walked up to her, crying about her twin brother. The ditzzy heiress shifted uncomfortably, obviously not used to dealing with other people's emotions. "I'm just going to come out and say it," said the heiress, "because I owe it to our ship to do that. It's rude to cry in front of other people." *[A/N bad ship, I know, but it has my third, fifth, sixth, seventh and ninth favorite characters :3]*

The ditzzy heiress got up suddenly and left, but left behind her dinner. A large hairy fellow swooped in with eyes only for the food. "Can I have that? I'm making a pic-a-nic basket for later," he said. The cheerleader waved for him to continue, although she was lightly disgusted. *I don't even think he's human*, she thought to herself. *Although our ship would be a beautiful gemstone*. Maybe an emerald or an aquamarine. She shook her head and prepared to head out. *[A/N: This ship is kinda gross but I couldn't resist! It's the only one in the entire fic that uses only my favorite characters!!!!]*

As she left, a handsome-looking military man with a wry grin sauntered over to the hairy fellow, explaining that he'd been deployed over in Korea. He'd apparently been a doctor of some sort, but wouldn't stop talking about hot lips. The military man leaned over and examined the Eastern European dumplings that the hairy fellow was packing into his picnic basket. "You know, if we were together one of those could be our ship," observed the military man. *[A/N this ship's a good one because it has my first, fourth, eighth, eleventh, and twelfth favorite characters!!!]*

The hairy fellow was taken aback, so he picked up his basket and skedaddled. The military man sat down in his seat and looked up to see someone approaching. *Who's this approaching?* The military man thought. *He sure looks intriguing. Looks like a real family man, although his style is a bit dated, looks like he hasn't updated his wardrobe in a few decades.* The military man struck up a conversation with the family man, but was quickly taken aback when talk turned to kicking his kids out of his basement and putting his foot in their asses. The family man blathered on, oblivious to the military man's discomfort. "If we were dating, our ship would be an overnight one," he said. "Leave in the evening and arrive the next morning." *[A/N my second, tenth, eleventh, twelfth favorite characters are in this one!!]*

The military man decided that he'd had enough of that and called for a medivac. The family man's eyes perked up when he noticed a brunette over by the bar pretending not to listen in on their conversation. *Seems like she perked up when I threatened the last guy*, he thought. *She seems intrigued, no, enticed by the idea. Heck, if we got together, we could be a guy made of fortified iron!* *[A/N ahh, a ship with my third, fifth, ninth and eleventh favorite characters!!]*

Before he reached her, however, a different man swooped in, one who oozed the impression of being very good at BDSM out of his very pores. The brunette smiled at him. "You're who I'm meant to be with," she said as he approached. The BDSM man nodded, and glanced over at the table that Bella and Edward had sat at earlier that evening. "It's true," he said, raising a glass. "You are the Bella to my Edward."

[author's note: Ok, so I wanted to write the best fanfiction ever, but I was having trouble figuring out what should go in it, but then I realized that the answer was just that I should write about my twelve favorite characters, duh!! Hope you enjoyed it, and lemme know what you thought of my favs! :]]